CONTRIBUTION TO NATIONAL LEVEL INITIATIVE OF GOVERNMENT OF INDIA SWACHH BHARAT

Name of the Activity:

Cleanliness Drive at APMC Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple

Objectives:

- To promote awareness on the importance of cleanliness and hygiene in public places.
- To encourage community participation in maintaining clean markets and religious places.
- To support the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan by reducing waste accumulation in high-traffic areas.
- To motivate students and local citizens to follow proper waste disposal practices.

About :

The Cleanliness Drive conducted on 13th September at APMC Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple was organized as a contribution to the national initiative Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. The purpose of this activity was to spread awareness on hygiene, reduce waste in public areas, and involve students in community service. Through active participation, volunteers cleaned the market surroundings and temple premises, interacted with the public, and promoted proper waste disposal habits. This activity aimed to support the Government of India's mission to create a cleaner, healthier, and more responsible society

Fig 1.0 Group photo of volunteers at APMC Sullia during the Cleanliness Drive

Location:

APMC Market, Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple , Sullia

Fig 1.1 Cleanness Drive at Bagavathi Temple

Overview of Swachh Bharat Abhiyan:

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan is one of the largest cleanliness campaigns in the world, launched by the **Government of India on 2nd October 2014** with the objective of creating a clean, hygienic, and garbage-free nation. The mission was initiated as a tribute to Mahatma Gandhi's vision of a clean India, and it aims to bring a significant transformation in the country's sanitation practices and public awareness regarding cleanliness.

The program focuses on improving both **urban and rural sanitation** through various initiatives such as building household and community toilets, promoting waste segregation, encouraging recycling, eliminating open defecation, and developing sustainable waste management systems. It emphasizes reducing the use of single-use plastics, promoting public participation, and ensuring cleanliness in government institutions, markets, streets, villages, and all public places.

A major goal of the mission is to encourage **behavioural change** among citizens. Instead of treating cleanliness as merely the responsibility of municipal workers, the Abhiyan urges every individual to participate actively in maintaining cleanliness. Schools, colleges, industries, government departments, and NGOs all play a crucial role in spreading awareness and volunteering for cleanliness drives.

Swachh Bharat also promotes scientific waste disposal methods, awareness of health and hygiene, and environmental protection. Under this mission, several cities have improved their cleanliness ranking through efforts such as door-to-door waste collection, waste segregation at source, community dustbins, and awareness programs conducted by local authorities and volunteers.

Overall, Swachh Bharat Abhiyan is not just a cleanliness program but a **mass movement** that motivates citizens to adopt long-term sustainable habits. It aims to build a cleaner, healthier, and more responsible India by involving people of all age groups and social backgrounds.

Detailed Report of the Activity

The Cleanliness Drive conducted on **13th September** as part of the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan was a well-planned and systematically executed activity carried out at two important public locations in Sullia: **APMC Market** and **Bhagavathi Temple premises**. The main objective of this drive was to promote cleanliness, create awareness among the public, and involve students in community service. The activity saw enthusiastic participation from students, volunteers, and coordinators, making it a meaningful and impactful initiative.

Pre-Activity Planning

The coordinators explained the significance of Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and the purpose behind choosing APMC Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple for the drive. Students were instructed about safety precautions, waste segregation methods, and respectful interaction with the public. Volunteers were then divided into teams All materials such as gloves, masks, garbage bags, brooms, and sanitizers were distributed .

Activity at Bhagavathi Temple

Upon reaching Bagavathi Temple Sullia a spiritual and cultural center of the locality. Being a frequently visited space, the temple premises had dry leaves, flowers, plastic covers, and other small waste items.

Fig 1.3 Activity at Bhagavathi Temple

Activity at APMC Sullia

After completing the Bagavathi Temple cleaning, volunteers moved to **APMC Sullia**, the volunteers observed that the market area had a mixture of dry and wet waste—plastic covers, cardboard, vegetable leftovers, and fruit waste. After a quick assessment, students began working according to their team assignments. We worked among the vegetable and fruit stalls. They collected large amounts of vegetable waste, plastic bags, and wrappers which were scattered near the vendor spaces And focused on the sides of the road and the parking area where dry waste like plastic cups, paper pieces, and bottles were found.

Most vendors responded positively and appreciated the our' effort. A few vendors even helped by pointing out commonly littered areas. Overall, the cleaning at APMC took approximately an hour and significantly improved the appearance and hygiene of the market surroundings.

Fig 1.4 Activity at APMC Sullia

Overall Impact

The cleanliness drive created a positive impact on both locations. APMC Sullia appeared much more organized and tidy after the cleaning, and the temple premises looked more peaceful and welcoming. The activity also created awareness among vendors, shopkeepers, and visitors, motivating them to maintain cleanliness regularly.

For students, the drive served as a practical learning experience that built responsibility, empathy, and social awareness. It also strengthened community bonding and contributed directly to the objectives of the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan.

Outcomes and Achievements

The Cleanliness Drive conducted at **APMC Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple** on 12th November resulted in several meaningful and measurable outcomes that contributed to the objectives of the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. The collective efforts of students and volunteers created a visible improvement in the cleanliness of both locations and strengthened community awareness about hygiene and responsible waste disposal.

One of the major achievements was the **complete removal of accumulated waste**, including plastic wrappers, dry leaves, food waste, and discarded materials around the market premises and temple surroundings. The area looked significantly cleaner and more organized after the activity. Dustbins were rearranged, and pathways were cleared, creating a more hygienic environment for the public and devotees.

Another important outcome was the **positive response from local vendors, shopkeepers, and temple authorities**. Many expressed their appreciation and shared that such activities encourage them to maintain cleanliness regularly. Some even joined the students in cleaning, showing increased community participation and willingness to support future initiatives.

The activity also achieved its goal of spreading awareness. Students interacted with visitors and locals, explaining the importance of **waste segregation, reducing single-use plastic, and keeping public places clean**. Pamphlets or verbal awareness messages helped in educating people about the long-term benefits of cleanliness and environmental care.

Fig 1.5 Collecting and Disposing waste

For the students involved, the drive fostered a strong sense of teamwork, responsibility, and social commitment. Participants learned how community cooperation can bring visible change in a short time. The activity enhanced leadership skills and built confidence in taking part in national initiatives such as Swachh Bharat Abhiyan.

Overall, the Cleanliness Drive succeeded in creating a cleaner environment, improving public awareness, and strengthening student-community bonding. The achievements reflect the impact that even small voluntary actions can have on society when carried out with dedication and unity.

Knowledge Gained

Through this cleanliness drive, I gained valuable awareness about the importance of maintaining hygiene in public places and how small actions can create a big impact in the community. I understood the practical challenges involved in waste management, such as segregation, collection, and proper disposal. Participating in the activity taught me how teamwork, coordination, and a sense of responsibility can bring visible change in a short time.

I also learned how community involvement plays a major role in the success of national initiatives like Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. Interacting with the public helped me improve my communication skills and made me more confident in spreading awareness about cleanliness. Most importantly, this activity strengthened my commitment to contribute regularly towards creating a cleaner and healthier environment.

Conclusion

The Cleanliness Drive conducted at APMC Sullia and Bhagavathi Temple on 13th September successfully contributed to the goals of the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. The active participation of students and the positive response from the local community helped create a cleaner and more hygienic environment in both locations. The activity not only improved the surroundings but also created awareness about the importance of waste management and personal responsibility in maintaining public spaces.

This initiative helped students develop teamwork, leadership, and civic responsibility, reinforcing the idea that cleanliness is a shared duty. The drive demonstrated that even small collective efforts can lead to meaningful change. Overall, the activity strengthened our commitment to support national initiatives and encouraged us to continue promoting cleanliness and environmental care in our community.